

issue the license and perform the ceremony. By that time they were totally broke and running out of time before classes started.

“That’ll be twenty-five dollars,” the justice said. “And thirty for the license.”

“Will you take a credit card?” Andrea asked meekly.

“Sorry, ma’am, cash only,” the justice responded brusquely.

“But we don’t have any cash,” Andrea pleaded. “Will you take a check?”

“I normally take cash only. It’s Saturday night, and nobody can cash your check until Monday. You kids don’t have any money at all?” he asked looking at Bill.

“No, sir,” Bill replied.

“Well, I guess I’ll have to take a check then,” he said irritably, “but I’ll need some collateral. I’ve been stiffed by too many of you college kids already.”

“What kind of collateral?” Andrea asked nervously. She knew that if they didn’t get a license, they weren’t legally married.

“I’ll take that watch you’re wearing,” he told Bill, pointing at his watch.

“But that’s brand new,” Andrea protested. “And it was a gift from me.”

“Well, take it or leave it,” the justice said gruffly. “Otherwise you can wait until Monday and cash your check at the bank.”

“No, we can’t wait,” Bill said as he removed the watch. “Can we get it back after the check clears?”

“Why sure, kids. You just drop me a note, and I’ll send it right along,” he said with a chuckle.



A month later Andrea’s mother called her. “Andrea, I’ve been looking through some of the bills from my bank, and I see that the credit card is over limit. I called our banker, and he said he had let